Accessibility report

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WCAG 2.2 Accessibility Checklist: Moodle Course Template

The Moodle course template should meet WCAG 2.2 Level AA, which includes every Level A criterion. Items marked **[site]** need site or theme access; everything else can be handled in the template's content and design.

New in WCAG 2.2

- **2.4.11 Focus Not Obscured (AA):** a focused element must not be completely hidden by other content. Moodle's sticky header, sticky footer and open drawers can cover focused links when tabbing. **[site]** to fix, but you can test it by tabbing through a page.
- **2.5.7 Dragging Movements (AA):** anything done by dragging needs a single-pointer alternative, such as buttons or a menu. This affects drag-and-drop quiz questions, reordering in the course index and some H5P types.
- **2.5.8 Target Size, Minimum (AA):** clickable targets should be at least 24×24 CSS px, or have enough spacing around them. Check small icons, edit/collapse toggles, close buttons and inline links in dense lists. **[site]** for theme CSS.
- **3.2.6 Consistent Help (A):** if you offer help (support link, contact, chat), put it in the same relative place on every page. Put it in the template header or footer.
- **3.3.7 Redundant Entry (A):** don't make people re-enter information they already gave in the same process. This matters for multi-step forms and submissions.
- **3.3.8 Accessible Authentication, Minimum (AA):** login can't rely on a cognitive test such as remembering a password or solving a puzzle unless there's an alternative. Allow paste and password managers and avoid CAPTCHAs that rely on puzzles. **[site]**
- **4.1.1 Parsing was removed** in 2.2, so you no longer need to audit for it.

1. Perceivable

Text alternatives

- 1.1.1: Every meaningful image needs alt text. Decorative images get empty alt text. Complex images such as charts and diagrams need a longer description nearby.
- Don't put text inside images. This includes banners, headers and infographics.

Time-based media

- 1.2.1–1.2.5: Videos need accurate captions (not auto-captions left uncorrected). Audio-only content needs a transcript, and video needs an audio description or a text alternative for visual-only information.

Adaptable structure

- 1.3.1: Use real headings in a logical order (H1 → H2 → H3, with no skipped levels). Use real lists, and use table headers on data tables only, never for layout.
- 1.3.2: Reading order must make sense without CSS.
- 1.3.4: Don't lock the content to portrait or landscape.
- 1.3.5: Form fields collecting personal data need correct autocomplete attributes. **[site]**

Distinguishable

- 1.4.1: Don't use colour alone to convey meaning, for example "required fields in red" or "click the green button".
- 1.4.3: Text contrast must be at least 4.5:1, or 3:1 for large text (18pt or 14pt bold and up). Check every brand colour pairing, including text on banners and buttons.
- 1.4.4: Text must resize to 200% without loss of content.
- 1.4.5: Use real text, not images of text.
- 1.4.10: Content must reflow at 320px width (400% zoom) without two-dimensional scrolling. Watch wide tables and embedded content.
- 1.4.11: UI components (buttons, input borders, icons) and meaningful graphics need 3:1 contrast against their background.
- 1.4.12: Content must survive user-adjusted text spacing without clipping or overlap.
- 1.4.13: Hover and focus popups (tooltips) must be dismissible, hoverable and persistent.

2. Operable

Keyboard

- 2.1.1: Everything works with the keyboard alone.
- 2.1.2: No keyboard traps. Check embedded H5P, video players and iframes in particular.
- 2.1.4: Single-character shortcuts must be turn-off-able or remappable.

Enough time

- 2.2.1: Timed activities such as quizzes need an option to extend or adjust the time. Moodle's quiz time-limit overrides cover this.

- 2.2.2: Anything that moves, blinks or auto-updates for more than 5 seconds needs pause, stop or hide controls. This includes auto-advancing carousels.

Seizures

- 2.3.1: Nothing flashes more than three times per second.

Navigable

- 2.4.1: Provide a "skip to main content" link. Moodle's default has one, so make sure the template doesn't break it.
- 2.4.2: Every page needs a descriptive title.
- 2.4.3: Focus order must be logical.
- 2.4.4: Link text must make sense in context. Avoid "click here" and "read more".
- 2.4.5: Offer more than one way to find pages, such as the course index plus search or breadcrumbs.
- 2.4.6: Headings and labels must be descriptive.
- 2.4.7: The keyboard focus indicator must always be visible. Don't remove outlines in CSS.
- 2.4.11: See "New in WCAG 2.2" above.

Input modalities

- 2.5.1: Multi-touch or path-based gestures need a single-pointer alternative.
- 2.5.2: Actions fire on release (up-event), not on press, so they can be cancelled.
- 2.5.3: A control's accessible name must contain its visible label.
- 2.5.4: Motion-triggered actions need an alternative.
- 2.5.7 and 2.5.8: See "New in WCAG 2.2" above.

3. Understandable

- 3.1.1: Declare the page language. **[site]**
- 3.1.2: Mark passages in a different language with a language attribute.
- 3.2.1 and 3.2.2: Focusing on or changing a field must not trigger an unexpected change of context, such as auto-submitting a dropdown.
- 3.2.3 and 3.2.4: Navigation and repeated components must look and behave consistently, and the template should give every course the same structure.
- 3.2.6: See "New in WCAG 2.2" above.
- 3.3.1: Errors must be identified and described in text.

- 3.3.2: Every input needs a visible label or instructions.
- 3.3.3: Suggest corrections where possible.
- 3.3.4: Legal, financial or data-changing submissions must be reversible, checked or confirmed.
- 3.3.7 and 3.3.8: See "New in WCAG 2.2" above.

4. Robust

- 4.1.2: All UI components need a name, role and state exposed to assistive tech. Custom widgets such as accordions, tabs and modals need correct ARIA, and native elements are better. Prefer Moodle's built-in components.
- 4.1.3: Status messages (saved, error, quiz submitted) must be announced to screen readers without moving focus. Moodle's toast notifications and form errors need to be tested.

Moodle-specific things to check in the template

- **Section and activity names:** make them unique and descriptive, because screen reader users navigate by them.
- **Course page layout:** keep the same structure and section order across every course so navigation stays predictable.
- **Files:** uploaded PDFs, Word docs and slides must be accessible themselves (tagged, with headings and alt text).
- **Embeds:** check iframes, H5P and third-party tools for keyboard access, captions and contrast, because you can't fix them from the template.
- **Editor tools:** use the built-in accessibility checker in Moodle's text editor, and check tables, links and images when authoring content.
- **Tables:** don't use tables to lay out content.
- **Dark and custom themes:** re-check contrast after any colour change.

Suggested way to test

1. Run an automated scan (WAVE, axe DevTools or Lighthouse). These catch roughly a third of issues.
2. Tab through the page with the keyboard only and check focus visibility and order (2.4.7, 2.4.11).
3. Zoom to 200% and 400%, and test at 320px width.
4. Test with a screen reader (NVDA on Windows, VoiceOver on Mac).
5. Run a colour contrast check on every brand colour pair.

Doable now vs needs site access

Doable now, in content and design:

- Contrast
- Alt text
- Heading structure
- Link wording
- Captions and transcripts
- Video and file accessibility
- Colour-only cues
- Consistent help placement in the design spec

Needs site or theme access [site]:

- Focus visibility and not-obscured fixes
- Target sizes
- Skip link
- Page language
- Autocomplete
- Authentication
- Drag alternatives
- ARIA fixes in custom components